

# Session 5: Tale of Two Seeds

## Key Takeaways

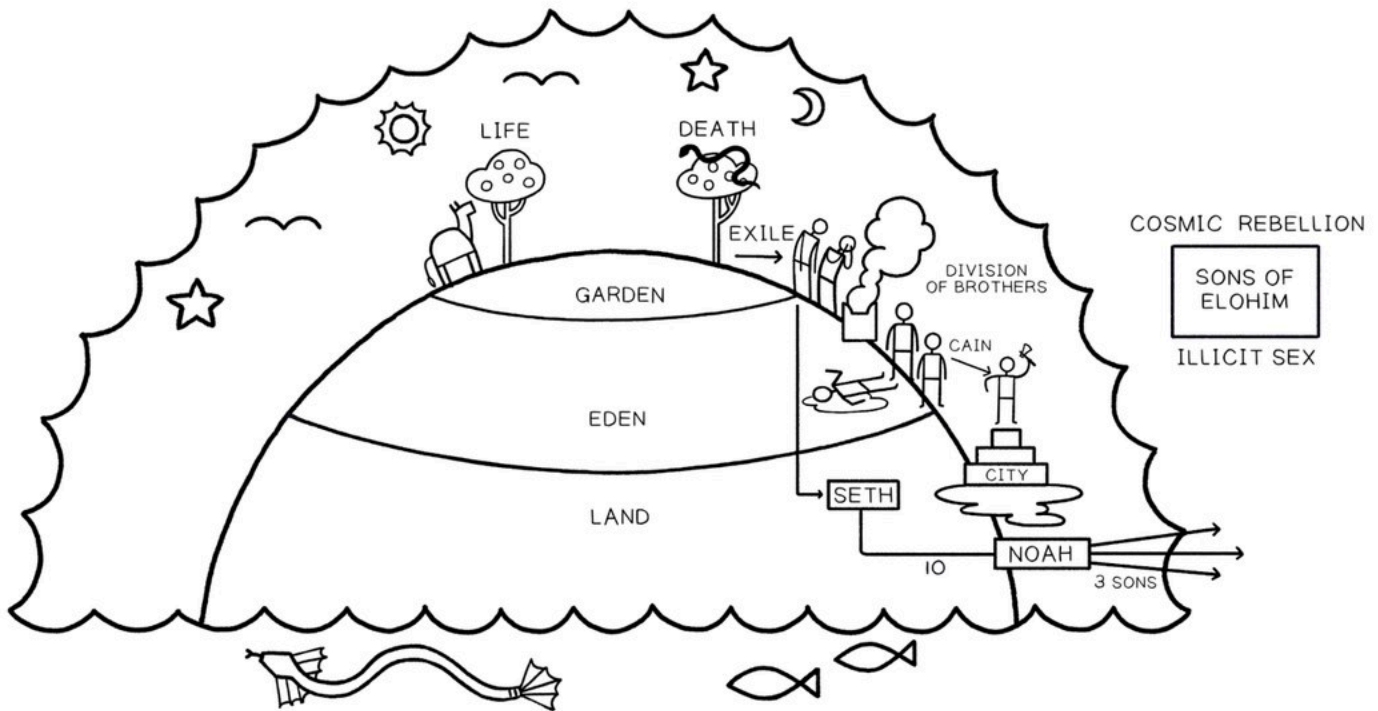
- It is not inevitable that Cain replays his parents' failure. Each generation faces its own testing.
- Genesis 4 and 5 gives us two genealogies, first Cain's and then Seth's—the seed of the snake and the seed of the woman. Cain starts off as the seed of the woman, but by his choices, he aligns himself with the seed of the snake.
- The continuation of Noah's genealogy in 6:9-10, 7:6, and 9:28-29 shows the seams where biblical authors wove two narratives into a unified story.

## The Cycle of Themes in Genesis 1-11

| Unit                                                                                                 |                                                                                                               | Theme                      |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| <b>A1</b>                                                                                            | 1:1-2:3 Creation of sacred cosmos from chaos waters / human image of God / blessing / fruitful and multiply   | Creation and Blessing      |
| <b>B1</b>                                                                                            | 2:4-3:24 Mountain-garden temple / sin, nakedness, curse, exile                                                | Failure                    |
| <b>B2</b>                                                                                            | 4:1-16 Next generation sins / brothers divide / firstborn not chosen / curse, exile                           | Failure of Next Generation |
| <b>C1</b>                                                                                            | 4:17-26 Adam to Lemek: 7 generations + 3 sons / city of Cain / murder / 70 x 7                                | Non-Chosen                 |
| <b>C2</b>                                                                                            | 5:1-32 Adam to Noah: 10 generations + 3 sons / promise of comfort                                             | Chosen                     |
| <b>B3</b>                                                                                            | 6:1-8 Cosmic rebellion in Heaven and Earth: sons of God invade the land, leading to the flood                 | Cosmic Rebellion           |
| <b>A2</b>                                                                                            | 6:9-9:19 De-creation by chaos waters and recreation / Noah as new humanity / blessing / fruitful and multiply | Re-Creation and Blessing   |
| Macro-Design of Genesis 1-11. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Adam to Noah (2020). |                                                                                                               |                            |

| Unit                                                                                                 |           |                                                                                                | Theme                      |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
|                                                                                                      | <b>B1</b> | 9:20-21 Garden vineyard / sin, nakedness                                                       | Failure                    |
|                                                                                                      | <b>B2</b> | 9:22-27 Next generation sins / brothers divide / firstborn not chosen / curse, scattering      | Failure of Next Generation |
|                                                                                                      | <b>C1</b> | 10:1-32 Noah + 3 sons / 7 generations to Peleg / City of Babylon and Assyria / 70 nations      | Non-Chosen                 |
|                                                                                                      | <b>B3</b> | 11:1-9 Cosmic rebellion in Babylon: sons of Adam invade the heavens, leading to the scattering | Cosmic Rebellion           |
|                                                                                                      | <b>C2</b> | 11:10-26 Shem to Abram: 10 generations / 3 sons                                                | Chosen                     |
| <b>A3</b>                                                                                            |           | 12:1-9 Abram as new humanity / blessing / fruitful and multiply                                | Re-Creation and Blessing   |
| Macro-Design of Genesis 1-11. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Adam to Noah (2020). |           |                                                                                                |                            |

## Genesis 5:1-32: Ten Generations From Adam to Noah



*From Adam to Noah's Three Sons. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Noah to Abraham (2020).*

After the humans are exiled from Eden, and after the drama of election that splits Adam and Eve's family into two lines, the narrative reboots and begins again. This time, the genealogy follows the line of Seth, Cain's line having been concluded with Lemek and sons. This genealogy has a highly schematic form, which makes the three "narrative inserts" stick out.

## Literary Design of Each Generation

This genealogy lists ten generations from Adam to Noah. Each one is given in an identical literary form:

*And \_\_\_ lived \_\_\_ years, and he caused the birth of [son's name].*

*And \_\_\_ lived \_\_\_ years after he caused the birth of [sons' name], and he caused the birth of sons and daughters,*

*and all the days of \_\_\_ were \_\_\_ years,*

*and he died.*

## Three Special People in Genesis 5

There are three figures whose genealogical entry deviates from this form, and at precisely these three points we find narrative inserts that highlight important themes of Genesis. Pay special attention to Adam, Enoch, and Lemek/Noah.

<sup>1</sup> This is the scroll of the generations of **Adam** ;  
In the day when Elohim created **humanity** ,  
he made him as the likeness of Elohim,  
male and female he created them,  
and he blessed them  
and he named them **'human'**  
in the day when they were created.

## 10 Generations

### Adam

<sup>3</sup> And Adam had lived one hundred and thirty years,  
and he caused the birth of one  
**in his own likeness ,**  
**according to his image ,**  
**and named him Seth .**

<sup>4</sup> And the days of Adam after he caused the birth of Seth were eight hundred years,  
and he caused the birth of sons and daughters.

<sup>5</sup> And all the days that Adam lived were nine hundred and thirty years,  
and he died.

### Seth

<sup>6</sup> And Seth lived one hundred and five years,  
and he caused the birth of Enosh.

<sup>7</sup> And Seth lived eight hundred and seven years after he caused the birth of Enosh,  
and he he caused the birth of sons and daughters,

<sup>8</sup> and all the days of Seth were nine hundred and twelve years,  
and he died.

### Enosh

<sup>9</sup> And Enosh lived ninety years,  
and he caused the birth of Cainan.

<sup>10</sup> And Enosh lived eight hundred and fifteen years after he caused the birth of Cainan,  
and he caused the birth of sons and daughters.

<sup>11</sup> And all the days of Enosh were nine hundred and five years,  
and he died.

### Cainan

<sup>12</sup> And Cainan lived seventy years,  
and he caused the birth of Mahalalel.

<sup>13</sup> And Cainan lived eight hundred and forty years after he he caused the birth of Mahalalel,  
and he caused the birth of sons and daughters.

<sup>14</sup> And all the days of Cainan were nine hundred and ten years,